

The Courage to Try Again: A Parent Reflection Guide

Purpose: To help parents reframe mistakes and failures into opportunities for learning and connection. – Episode #9 Parent Resource

Reflection Begins

Opening Thought:

“Mistakes are proof that you are trying.” – Jennifer Lim

Every mistake your teen makes offers a mirror — for them and for you. This guide invites you to reflect on how you respond when things go wrong, and how your reactions can shape your teen’s courage to try again.

Quick Reflection:

- When my teen fails, do I focus on the outcome or the effort?
- What tone do I use — curious, anxious, angry, or calm?
- How did my own parents handle my mistakes when I was growing up?



Understanding the Growth Zone

Why Mistakes Matter

Research from Stanford University's Carol Dweck (2016) shows that teens who believe abilities can improve through effort — not talent — are more resilient after setbacks. Parents play the key role in modeling this mindset

Try This Exercise:

For one week, note three times your teen made a small mistake. Instead of correcting instantly, ask:

- "What do you think happened?"
- "What might work better next time?"

Write your observations here:



The 4A Model in Practice

Acknowledge – Ask – Align – Act

Revisit this after a conflict or disappointment.

- What effort can I acknowledge?
- What reflective question can I ask?
- How can I align emotionally before giving advice?
- What action step can we plan together?

Example:

“When you forgot your assignment, I noticed you felt upset. I appreciate that you’re owning it. Let’s see how you can plan reminders for next time.”

This approach creates safety, not shame — the ground on which learning stands.



Self-Check for Parents

Quick Quiz:

Rate 1–5 (1 = rarely, 5 = always)

1. I stay calm when my teen fails.
2. I help them reflect instead of rushing to fix.
3. I share my own past mistakes openly.
4. I focus on lessons, not punishment.
5. I give genuine second chances.

If your total is below 15, that's okay — awareness is step one. Every point higher is a sign of growing empathy and trust.

Your Action Plan:

Write one sentence to your teen that communicates acceptance after failure:

Say it today — not after the next mistake.

